

SOP-SCAF-1600: Scaffold Erection, Inspection, and Use

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Section 1. Purpose and Scope

Governs erection, modification, inspection, and use of supported scaffolds.

Section 2. Competent Person Requirement

Clause 2.1 — Scaffold erection, dismantling, and any modification shall be performed under the direction of a qualified competent person; general laborers may not modify scaffold configuration independently.

Section 3. Inspection and Tagging

Clause 3.1 — A completed scaffold shall be inspected by the competent person and tagged before first use: green tag (safe for use), yellow tag (safe for use with specific restrictions noted), or red tag (unsafe, do not use).

Clause 3.2 — Re-inspection and re-tagging is required daily before use, and after any event that could affect structural integrity (high wind, nearby impact, or any modification).

Section 4. Fall Protection

Clause 4.1 — Guardrails (top rail, mid rail, toe board) are required on any open side or end 10 feet or more above a lower level; where guardrails are not yet installed during erection, erectors shall use PFAS per SOP-FALL-900.

Section 5. Loading Limits

Clause 5.1 — Scaffold platforms shall not be loaded beyond their rated capacity (typically 25 lbf/ft² light duty, verify against the specific scaffold's rating) — materials and personnel combined.

Section 6. Access

Clause 6.1 — A scaffold 4 feet or higher requires a proper access point (ladder, stair tower, or ramp); climbing cross-bracing as an access method is prohibited.

Section 7. Records

Clause 7.1 — Inspection tags and competent-person sign-offs are retained at the scaffold location for its duration and filed to the Construction Safety File for 3 years after removal.